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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

NEW-LOOK AL MAMZAR BEACH REOPENS

People jog at Al Mamzar Beach following its much-anticipated reopening. The iconic destination returns with upgraded facilities, expanded spaces and a refreshed look after a complete redesign. Backed by a Dh500 million investment, the project is part of Dubai Municipality's plan to transform the city's beaches into modern, family-friendly destinations.

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AGGRESSOR IRAN'S STRIKES ON UAE SPARK GLOBAL OUTRAGE

UAE intercepts Iranian missiles for second day

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received phone calls from Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman and leaders of Egypt and Qatar, all expressing solidarity with the UAE and condemning Iranian attacks. A broader wave of global condemnation followed, with leaders denouncing the strikes as a grave violation of sovereignty and international law and warning of a dangerous escalation.

Worsening the crisis

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said Iran is the aggressor responsible for worsening the crisis in the Arabian Gulf and posing an ongoing threat to regional security and stability.

In a post on X, Gargash said: "We appreciate and value the Gulf, Arab and international

US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Washington is 'not looking for a fight' but warned any attack on commercial shipping would draw a 'devastating' response.

messages of solidarity with the UAE, which condemn the brutal Iranian attack and reflect the international community's commitment to a system based on values and responsibility that rejects rogue behaviour and isolates its perpetrators."

He added that regional and international positions reinforced the view that Tehran bears responsibility for escalating tensions following a series of drone and missile attacks targeting the UAE and other GCC states.

Even as international reactions mounted, the UAE said its air defences were actively engaging incoming threats for the second

consecutive day yesterday. "UAE air defence systems are actively engaging with missiles and UAV threats," the Ministry of Defence said, adding the projectiles had originated from Iran.

Readiness to escalate

Meanwhile, US military officials signalled readiness to escalate if required. General Dan Caine said forces remain prepared to resume major combat operations against Iran if ordered.

An US official indicated President Donald Trump could authorise action if diplomacy stalls, while Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Washington is "not looking for a fight" but warned any attack on commercial shipping would draw a "devastating" response.

The attacks delivered another shock to the global economy, with stocks sinking yesterday after crude prices surged a day earlier as the tensions raised fears over the truce, with no sign of a deal to reopen the strait.

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